

# **Measure the perceived social benefits of Cultural Institutions in university students in Thu Duc City, Ho Chi Minh City**

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## **Abstract**

Cultural Institutions have been widely studied for their various social benefits. This research specifically explores six dimensions of value: health-related, social, identity, image, economic, and educational. The objective was to elucidate the significance of Cultural Institutions in social development by examining university students' perceptions of their societal advantages. Surveys were administered to university students in Ho Chi Minh City, assessing these social benefits using a 5-point Likert scale. The data were subsequently analyzed using SPSS software. The findings revealed that the "Economic" aspect received the highest rating, followed by "Social", "Educational", "Identity", and "Health", with "Image" ranked last. These insights can assist universities, cultural institution managers, and policymakers in designing programs and initiatives that effectively address social needs.

*Keywords:* Cultural Institution, Perceived Benefits, Culture, University Students, Social Value

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## **1. Introduction**

### ***1.1. Background and Context***

#### ***1.1.1. The Significance of Cultural Values***

According to UNESCO, culture is a set of beliefs, practices, aesthetics, and ways of life that help each country celebrate its individuality. All aspects of life (of each individual and society) that have happened in the past and are happening now are vividly expressed broadly. The centuries have seen the development of culture. Human behavior is guided and regulated by cultural ideals. In a nutshell, values orientation guides people in choosing their life's objectives, strategies, and course of action and so controlling ideas and actions through social and communal norms. Furthermore, each nation is defined by its cultural values, which have been cultivated and maintained throughout many years of history. Space and time are the two elements that give people, places, and nations their independence and individuality.

Additionally, social and artistic values are strongly related since art frequently mirrors and shapes society. With its ability to question conventions, spark debate, and spur social and political change, art may influence society. In addition to promoting cultural variety and creating empathy and understanding among other communities, it can be used as a vehicle for expressing and addressing societal issues.

A work of art's intrinsic value is determined by its aesthetic qualities, ingenuity, originality, and ability to elicit strong feelings or thoughts in the audience or viewer. The subjective nature of artistic worth makes it contingent upon personal inclinations and cultural milieu. It can strengthen communal ties and a sense of belonging by honouring and promoting cultural identity, customs, and rituals. In addition, art can question cultural norms, undermine long-standing social structures, and advance equality and social justice. Artists can use their art to engage with social issues, create awareness, and spark conversations that lead to beneficial societal transformations.

To create cultural values, one must uphold and advance traditional cultural values while also embracing the key ideas of global culture. Furthermore, preserving historic cultural values is essential to upholding and promoting the good cultural values of the country and fostering the cultural development of the nation. Moreover, absorbing the essence of global cultural values means acquiring progressive global cultural values that fit the country's development context, enhancing national culture, and improving the cultural and mental well-being of the populace.

#### 1.1.2. The Role of Cultural Institutions

Cultural institutions (CIs) have stated that one of the government's missions is to preserve, interpret, and disseminate information and seek to educate the general public about scientific, environmental, historical, and cultural topics. The United Nations aims to minimize the adverse impacts of urban activities on human health.

Living and working in Ho Chi Minh City draws individuals from all over the world, which contributes to the city's rich and diversified culture. To establish a vibrant, prosperous metropolis, Singapore does not alter its cultural characteristics—rather, it fosters them. To preserve cultural history, educate and increase knowledge, promote art and culture, establish community and cultural interchange, and develop cultural tourism, Ho Chi Minh City boasts hundreds of bookstores, a diverse museum system, cultural centers, children's clubhouses, libraries, etc.

Young people today often have new and creative perspectives that easily attract their peers. Furthermore, they always cherish the national culture and learn about and promote the values of

their ancestors thousands of years ago. It is undeniable its contribution and revitalization of values that seemed to have disappeared. Additionally, students also demonstrate a strong appreciation for national culture by actively learning and promoting long-standing cultural values.

The innovative and imaginative viewpoints of today's youth are highly appealing to their peers. Along with learning about and upholding the ideals of their predecessors from thousands of years ago, they also constantly preserve the national culture. Unquestionably, it has played a significant role in reviving values that had appeared to fade away. Students actively learn and uphold enduring cultural values, further demonstrating their deep admiration for the nation's culture.

### ***1.2. Problem Statement***

Economic changes since 1986 and worldwide trends have led to Vietnam's rapid development. With a 3.6-fold rise, the GDP per capita of the nation reached around 3,700 USD between 2002 and 2020. Vietnam effectively transitioned from being one of the world's poorest countries to a lower middle-income country, as seen by the drop in the poverty rate from over 14% in 2010 to 3.8% in 2020. While ethnic peoples' lives have significantly improved as a result of economic growth, many barriers to the preservation of culture, especially material culture, have also arisen. Attention is now needed to the pressing issue of promoting cultural identity and preserving cultural heritage. The whole social structure must work toward the preservation of material culture.

Students are a vital part of green city development, as they are a dynamic and creative workforce. They can contribute to green cities through various activities, such as promoting awareness and educating the community about the importance of green cities. They can also actively participate in environmental protection activities, such as planting trees and conserving energy and water. Additionally, they can develop creative solutions for green cities, such as renewable energy and public transportation, which can address environmental issues and improve city quality.

Numerous research have been conducted in this sector; however, the majority of them concentrate on areas like North America and Europe, which includes major nations like China and the United States. Up until now, there haven't been many research articles. special research on this subject, as well as how CI affects Vietnamese people generally and the Thu Duc region specifically. Due to differences in culture, lifestyle, and society, people's perceptions of cultural and social values, particularly in cultural institutions, might differ greatly from those of

individuals in other countries, making this study gap a serious problem. Therefore, measuring perceptions of social value through CI with its clear benefits will make an in-depth academic contribution and have practical value, especially in the context of Vietnam's integration strong.

The purpose of this study is to close this significant research gap by assessing students' knowledge of societal values and how those values affect their participation in CI activities. The goal of the study is to clarify particular elements impacting the advantages and offer insightful information for social and cultural research fields. Furthermore, it is anticipated that the results of this study will educate managers and policymakers on the advantages of cultural institutions and the demands of the populace, enabling the development of more specialized content and communication techniques. At last, closing this knowledge gap about Thu Duc locals' involvement with CI may inspire conversations and actions that influence how people use and visit cultural sites in Vietnam going forward.

The purpose of the study is to provide insight into how cultural institutions support youth social cohesiveness, identity formation, and community engagement by looking into students' opinions. Furthermore, this study intends to support the growth of cultural institutions in Thu Duc District and throughout Ho Chi Minh City, acknowledging the importance of creative and cultural advancement in society. The project aims to offer insights and recommendations for politicians, educators, and cultural institutions to improve the promotion and protection of cultural heritage in the region through the collection and analysis of empirical data servation of cultural heritage in the region.

## **2. Literature Review**

Recently, the study of cultural institutions has received considerable attention with many topics related to innovation, technology, society and economy in countries. Especially since the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic in early 2020, many museums in America have faced serious financial difficulties because profits from ticket sales and admission have decreased sharply for many months (Justin McIntosh, 2022). Regarding author Vo Quynh Trang's article on culture 2024, investing resources in establishing cultural institutions is another issue that the State and Party's Vietnam prioritize, allocating resources for building and perfecting the cultural institution system. Despite some positive developments, the cultural institution system still has major problems. Therefore, research and innovation to apply strategies related to the application of technology, the digital age, etc. to promote and restore cultural institutions are extremely important.

Several studies on cultural institutions applied to different aspects of innovation have been conducted and applied effectively; namely cultural institutions in the digital age; new technologies in cultural institutions; gamification and cultural institutions in cultural heritage promotion. These studies have been carried out and achieved certain results. First, the British Museum employs brand advocates - online friends who share museum content - to expand its audience reach (Spiliopoulou et al., 2014). This creates a "pyramid" of information sharing, allowing the museum to engage a broader audience without overwhelming them with frequent updates. Besides, new technologies enabled cultural institutions to create both economic and cultural value. For example, live broadcasts from the National Theatre were found to enhance the emotional and immersive experience for audiences, and the Tate's online exhibitions allowed visitors to engage more deeply with the content through interactive tools (Bakhshi and Throsby, 2012). Additionally, the success of using serious games (SGs) to engage users and promote cultural heritage, as demonstrated by the Mi Rasna game in Italy. It effectively increased visitor engagement and learning, allowing players to interact with realistic reconstructions of Etruscan culture while solving challenges (Bonacini and Giaccone, 2021).

Many previous research articles around the world have proposed different theories and arguments to analyze the value of CIs, however, the scope of one study is not enough to test and verify all of the benefits mentioned. Therefore, in this article, we only rely on 6 main categories, introduced by John Armbricht in his research article on the value of cultural institutions published in 2014. These categories have been researched and proven before, the paragraphs below will mention the theories and arguments of each category.

### ***2.1. Identity***

According to Mataraso (1997), cultural institutions and activities have a significant role in forming a sense of community identity by affecting how people view their surroundings and their relationships with one another. In 2013, Mark W. Moffett emphasized the importance of cultural identity as a component of social progress and as a valuable asset to society. In the contemporary setting, historical and cultural heritage values are especially well-suited for the expansion of societal identity through cultural institutions, which directly influence how each person is perceived in society. This leads to the depth of identification that individuals can achieve diminishes with the range of settings that shape people's identity.

Cultural values help to fortify the bond between culture and the community and offer significant practical values for communities with varied national identities. Callie Arrington (2017) asserts that community cooperation is crucial to sustaining fruitful relationships and that cultural organizations exist to help those in their immediate vicinity by fostering knowledge and

understanding. Cultural institutions should be interactive experiences that involve visitors and allow them to develop their meaning from history, not ivory towers where amazed audiences gather to stare reverently at artefacts in one instance. These amenities must be appealing and advantageous to the communities they serve in addition to tourists.

The current study it is believed that cultural institutions help people develop the cultural competencies required to comprehend both their own and other societies. This will lead to more control over one's environment, personality, and self. Scales were developed to measure their influence on an individual's identity, self-awareness, and cultural competence.

Hypothesis: cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's personal and social identity.

## ***2.2. Health***

Cultural institutions are places that gather cultural activities and cultural events from everywhere, attracting the attention of many audiences. Therefore, it even impacts people's physical and mental health in a positive direction.

Human life expectancy is increased when participating in cultural events. A study by Konlaan, Bygren, and Johansson in 2000 found that people who participated in cultural events had a lower risk of dying from all causes, including heart disease, cancer, and stroke. They also found that people who participated in cultural events had a higher life expectancy than those who did not.

Arts and culture play an important role in clinical psychological outcomes, improving health, changing work attitudes, and broadening the empathy of healthcare professionals towards gender and cultural diversity. A study by Staricoff in 2004 found that arts and culture programs can have a positive impact on the health and well-being of healthcare professionals. The study found that arts and culture programs can help healthcare professionals to (1) improve their clinical skills, (2) reduce stress and burnout (3) increase their empathy towards patients, (4) become more aware of cultural diversity, (5) develop a more positive attitude towards work.

Studies have indicated a correlation between mental and physical well-being. Items that demonstrate the connection between mental health and these institutions will be developed because it is difficult to discern a direct relationship between cultural institutions and physical health.

Hypothesis: cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's perceived social benefits to physical and mental health

### **2.3. Image**

It can be said that cultural activities enhance national prestige and bring pride according to the different reception of each individual (Bille Hansen, 1995). Organized cultural events showcase a nation's cultural heritage, values, and identity. These events serve as symbols of a country's image, both domestically and internationally. For example, the renowned Louvre Museum in Paris exudes sophistication and culture, instilling a sense of pride among Parisians and visitors alike.

At cultural institutions such as cultural events and festivals where people meet and communicate with many different people from many places (Boo & Busser, 2006; Waitt, 2008). It is an opportunity for people to express their opinions and understanding about a certain event or culture, from which communicators partly express the image of that culture in the way they communicate.

In general, the image of a national cultural institution can be expressed through cultural events about that country, famous monuments and symbols of the country, etc. This is also a place for people from different regions to meet and exchange, and is also an opportunity for the image of the cultural institution to spread.

Hypothesis: Cultural institutions are detected to have a commendatory effect on people's perceived social benefits to positive image.

### **2.4. Economic**

Cultural and artistic heritages have recently made significant contributions to the country's economy. According to Martishin (2015), culture plays a significant role in economic development. The strategic definition and promotion of cultural values can lead to tangible economic benefits for businesses and associated sectors. This aligns with Yerznkyan's (2016a) research, which highlights the multifaceted impact of culture on the economy, encompassing both quantifiable and qualitative aspects. Furthermore, cultural values are sustained through human creativity, exploration, and preservation efforts, resulting in cultural products that contribute to the national economic well-being. Cultural and national disparities in socioeconomic reform, as well as the interaction between culture, the economic system, and the cultural basis.

The measurement and evaluation of the economic value of CIs is also a matter of interest through the study of methods: Using the economic value-added method (EVA), cost-benefit analysis method (CBA), and the contingency pricing method (CVM) mentioned by Paweł

Wnuczak in 2017. Thenceforth, it is possible to determine the potential economic benefits of CIs for local governments and businesses in the region and for CIs to promote practical social activities, exploiting the potential of the region.

Accordingly, in this study, perceived social benefits to economic development mean that cultural institutions, which typically host festivals, operas, concerts, and other events, are thought to affect economic development since they encourage the expansion of tourism. Therefore, the items are designed to assess how much cultural institutions contribute to the growth of the local economy through tourism. Product topics that need to be covered are income inequality, entrepreneurship, and newly established companies. It is hypothesized that:

Hypothesis: Cultural institutions are observed to have a favourable influence on people's perceived social benefits to economic development.

### ***2.5. Education***

Although there are challenges in implementation and evaluation, social values have strengthened the public's role in heritage management and stimulated the development of new policies at various levels. Importantly, the study emphasizes that students can learn within the context of art, including inner dialogue and interpersonal engagement, thereby enabling children to understand and enhance their academic achievement, critical thinking skills, and a deeper appreciation for cultural diversity, museum visits improved critical thinking skills in analyzing representational art, with stronger effects for minority, small-town, and higher-poverty students (Brian Kisida, 2015).

Nowadays, cultural institutions focus on providing information access, facilitating self-directed learning, and offering information. Besides, the vast amount of information necessitates the exploration of tools that foster self-directed learning within cultural institutions. The growing importance of self-directed learning in society and the challenges posed by the vast amount of information available within cultural institutions can support self-directed learning. In this regard, the development of Web 2.0 tools exemplifies the widespread recognition of the importance of self-directed learning, demonstrating a concerted effort by society, researchers, and governments to enhance educational outcomes through the utilization of cultural institution (CI) resources. (Ebrahimzadeh & Parvini, 2015). In addition, the function of the cultural institution should be encouraging the creation and fostering of cultural goods, it should be a center of cultural life in an environment in which their content work will affect civic education. (Kocoska & Petrovski, 2015). Accordingly, teach art and have an impact on math and reading abilities. Cultural groups will also be able to disseminate information regarding skills that are



difficult to apply in other situations. Creativity and innovation processes can be used as proof of this. Consequently, this study will examine the processes of item creation, innovation, and knowledge and skill exchange.

In this study, education including self-directed learning contributes to the important role in cultural institutions which helps students enhance critical thinking and cultural appreciation. Cultural institutions also provide a valuable context for students to develop their interpersonal skills and understanding of cultural diversity.

Hypothesis: Cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's perceived social benefits of knowledge and skills.

## ***2.6. Social***

According to Robert Putnam's "Bowling Alone" (2002) the loss of social ties and community involvement has a negative impact on Americans' social cohesiveness and democratic strength, which in turn affects several macro-level phenomena like diffusion, social mobility, political organization, and social cohesion. Additionally, research by Mason and Throsby suggests strong social connections between people (social capital and sense of connection) can influence important social trends like the spread of ideas (diffusion), movement between social classes (social mobility), how governments are formed (political organization), and how well a society sticks together (social cohesion).

Culture plays an important role in social development. Cultural institutions can contribute to social development by providing cultural programs and activities for all, creating public spaces for people to meet and socialize, and encouraging the community to participate in cultural activities and promote understanding and respect for different cultures (Łukasz Wróblewski, 2020).

In the current study, perceived social benefits to favourable image mean that cultural institutions are observed to have a favourable influence on people's views of locations. A place will also be more livable if it has a positive reputation. The components of the scale should represent the impact of a cultural institution on the attraction and public image of a place.

Hypothesis: Cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's perceived social benefits of social network.

## ***2.7. Research Hypothesis***

When applying theories and concepts together, we can see that research is a combination of the variety of different cultural institutions and each individual's understanding of the benefits and rights of participating in cultural institutions.

H1: Cultural institutions are observed to have a favourable influence on people's perceived social benefits to economic development.

H2: Cultural institutions are detected to have a commendatory effect on people's perceived social benefits to positive image.

H3: Cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's personal and social identity.

H4: Cultural institutions positively affect social networks including meetings between individuals; political influence; and inclusion/exclusion in society.

H5: Cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's perceived social benefits of knowledge and skills.

H6: Cultural institutions have a positive impact on people's perceived social benefits to physical and mental health.

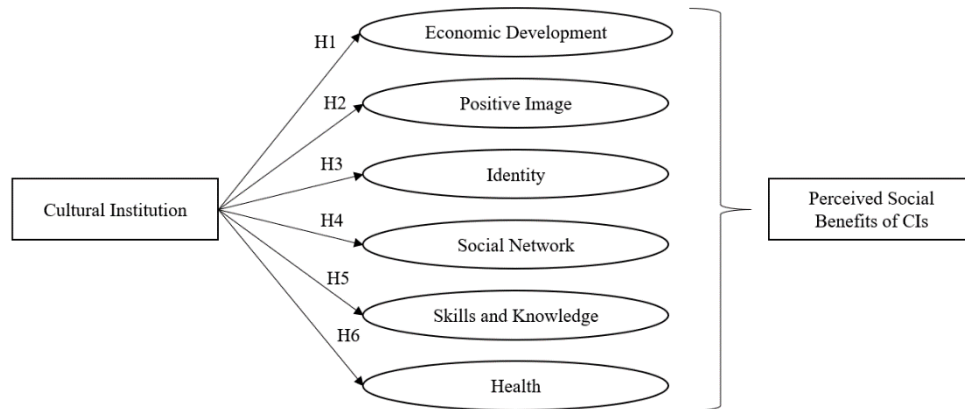


Figure 1. The Hypotheses Model

### 3. Methodology/Materials

#### 3.1. Sampling Method

The sample strategy selected for this study was convenience sampling. Defined as non-probability sampling, it is frequently used since it doesn't require a lot of work and is quick, easy, and inexpensive (Stratton, S. J., 2021). By using this approach, participants choose

whether or not to take part in the survey; the researcher simply needs to choose local, willing respondents until the position is filled. Convenience sampling might be useful in formulating a potential theory or research objective. Non-probability sampling techniques can be utilized when doing research aimed at delving deeper into a specific subject (e.g., purpose, motive, believing attitude, etc.), as probability sampling is not necessary.

Population: At the end of 2019, 1,013,795 people were living in Thu Duc city, which has a total area of 211.56 km<sup>2</sup>. Apart from Thu Duc City's economic advantages, people think it's a new neighborhood in Ho Chi Minh City that's worth residing in. The city has the benefit of fresh development space and land funding. According to Figure 2, Thu Duc has created safe, green living spaces for residents in residential developments, expansive metropolitan regions, and universities. This means that the study was purposefully conducted in this place.

Hair et al. (2014) state that a sample size of at least 50 is required to use EFA, but preferably 100 or more. Typically, there are five observations for every variable under analysis. The term "variable" refers to a survey measurement question, while "number of observations" refers to the total number of valid survey forms required. With 19 variables for perceived social benefits in this study, a minimum sample size of 95 would be required. More than 20 institutions in a variety of areas are located in Thu Duc City. The study's subjects were students from Thu Duc City. We will try to include as many survey respondents as we can to ensure the validity and reliability of the study's findings. This will assist us in eliminating any responses that are inaccurate or do not meet the requirements.

### ***3.1. Questionnaires and Data***

The questionnaire was carefully prepared, based on research by John Armbrrecht (2014) and other researchers on the same topic. The data will be collected. The survey consists of 2 parts, utilizing The "5-point Likert scale" (Strongly Agree, Agree, Neutral, Disagree, Strongly Disagree).

- Demographic Information:
  - Gender: Male/Female
  - University
- Perceived Social Benefits:
  - To evaluate perceived social benefits in participants

- 19 factors based on 6 categories: Economic Development, Positive Image, Identity, Health, Social Network, Skills and Knowledge
- Scale: 1 = “Strongly Disagree”, 2 = “Disagree”, 3 = “Neutral”, 4 = “Agree”, 5 = “Strongly Agree”.

Table 1. Questionnaires

| CODE                               | ITEMS                                                               | SCALE |   |   |   |   |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|---|---|---|---|
| <i><b>POSITIVE IMAGE</b></i>       |                                                                     |       |   |   |   |   |
| HA1                                | The CI makes me proud when I can read about it in the newspaper     | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| HA2                                | The CI makes the region more attractive to live in                  | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| HA3                                | The CI is an important motivation for visiting the region           | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| <i><b>SOCIAL NETWORK</b></i>       |                                                                     |       |   |   |   |   |
| XH1                                | The CI means that I have good social contacts                       | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| XH2                                | The CI implies meetings between people who would otherwise not meet | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| XH3                                | The CI reduces exclusion in the region                              | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| <i><b>SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE</b></i> |                                                                     |       |   |   |   |   |
| GD1                                | The CI enables learning                                             | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| GD2                                | The CI can disseminate knowledge that is otherwise hard to find     | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| GD3                                | The CI affects the learning process positively                      | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| <i><b>HEALTH</b></i>               |                                                                     |       |   |   |   |   |
| SK1                                | The CI helps the elderly in the region remain mentally vital        | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| SK2                                | The CI reduces stress                                               | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| SK3                                | The CI makes the elderly in the region feel better                  | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| <i><b>IDENTITY</b></i>             |                                                                     |       |   |   |   |   |
| BS1                                | The CI helps me understand why I am who I am                        | 1     | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

|            |                                    |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>BS2</b> | The CI helps me understand society | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

|            |                                           |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|-------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>BS3</b> | The CI affects how well I succeed at work | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|-------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

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***ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT***

|            |                                                  |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>KT1</b> | The CI helps businesses in the region earn money | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

|            |                                      |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|--------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>KT2</b> | The CI gives birth to new businesses | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|--------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

|            |                                                 |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>KT3</b> | The CI increases entrepreneurship in the region | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

|            |                                                      |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| <b>KT4</b> | The CI is good for the region's economic development | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|

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Explaining the categories:

Perceived social benefits to economic development: Cultural institutions, which typically host festivals, operas, concerts, and other events, are thought to affect economic development since they encourage the expansion of tourism. Therefore, the items are designed to assess how much cultural institutions contribute to the growth of the local economy through tourism. Product topics that need to be covered are income inequality, entrepreneurship, and newly established companies.

Perceived social benefits to favourable image: Cultural institutions are observed to have a favourable influence on people's views of locations. A place will also be more livable if it has a positive reputation. The components of the scale should represent the impact of a cultural institution on the attraction and public image of a place.

Perceived social benefits to identity: Additionally, it is believed that cultural institutions help people develop the cultural competencies required to comprehend both their own and other societies. This will lead to more control over one's environment, personality, and self. Scales were developed to measure their influence on an individual's identity, self-awareness, and cultural competence.

Perceived social benefits to social networks: Public spaces that encourage social contact are developed via the support of cultural institutions. Social contact will have an impact on the social relationships that individuals and/or organizations have. Measurements will be taken of the items' construction. To account for people's contributions to interactions and their consequences on politics, social integration, and social isolation, categories were developed to capture social value.

Perceived social benefits of knowledge and skills: Cultural institutions teach art and have an impact on math and reading abilities. Cultural groups will also be able to disseminate information regarding skills that are difficult to apply in other situations. Creativity and innovation processes can be used as proof of this. Consequently, this study will examine the processes of item creation, innovation, and knowledge and skill exchange.

Perceived social benefits to physical and mental health: Studies have indicated a correlation between mental and physical well-being. Items that demonstrate the connection between mental health and these institutions will be developed because it is difficult to discern a direct relationship between cultural institutions and physical health.

#### 4. Results/Findings

##### 4.1. Descriptive Analysis

The team surveyed students in Thu Duc City to gather information for the study, including biographical details and opinions regarding the advantages of cultural institutions. Following the survey time, we received 250 responses from numerous local universities. The data are displayed below.

Table 5.1. Gender Frequencies

| “GIOI TINH” |          |             |           |                 |                      |
|-------------|----------|-------------|-----------|-----------------|----------------------|
|             |          | “Frequency” | “Percent” | “Valid Percent” | “Cumulative Percent” |
| “Valid”     | “Male”   | 180         | 45.0      | 45.0            | 45.0                 |
|             | “Female” | 220         | 55.0      | 55.0            | 100.0                |
|             | “Total”  | 400         | 100.0     | 100.0           |                      |

Table 5.2. Universities Frequencies

| TRUONG |     |           |         |               |                    |
|--------|-----|-----------|---------|---------------|--------------------|
|        |     | Frequency | Percent | Valid Percent | Cumulative Percent |
| Valid  | FPT | 74        | 18.5    | 18.5          | 18.5               |

|         |     |       |       |       |
|---------|-----|-------|-------|-------|
| HUTECH  | 5   | 1.3   | 1.3   | 19.8  |
| HUB     | 48  | 12.0  | 12.0  | 31.8  |
| GTVT    | 51  | 12.8  | 12.8  | 44.5  |
| USSH    | 73  | 18.3  | 18.3  | 62.7  |
| HCMUT   | 50  | 12.5  | 12.5  | 75.3  |
| KHTN    | 54  | 13.5  | 13.5  | 88.8  |
| CNTT    | 38  | 9.5   | 9.5   | 98.3  |
| UFM     | 2   | .5    | .5    | 98.8  |
| ULAW    | 2   | .5    | .5    | 99.3  |
| NONGLAM | 1   | .3    | .3    | 99.5  |
| BCVT    | 1   | .3    | .3    | 99.8  |
| UEL     | 1   | .3    | .3    | 100.0 |
| Total   | 400 | 100.0 | 100.0 |       |

#### ***4.2. Reliability Test***

An essential precondition for surveying variables is reliability. "The Cronbach Theory." The range of values for the Cronbach's Alpha coefficient is [0,1] "The Cronbach's Alpha" coefficient has a range of values of [0,1].. Theoretically, a larger coefficient indicates greater reliability in the scale. That being said, this is not true. The fact that Cronbach's Alpha coefficient is excessively high (about 0.95 or above) indicates that many of the scale's variables are similar to one another; this phenomenon is known as overlap in the scale. The phenomenon known as overlap on the scale is shown by "The Cronbach's Alpha" coefficient being abnormally high (about 0.95 or above), which suggests that many of the variables on the scale are comparable to one another.

All factors have reliability >0.7, as the data table demonstrates, demonstrating the validity and reliability of the scale for use in result analysis.

Table 5.3. Reliability Test

| Factor         | N of Items | Cronbach's Alpha | Smallest Index Items | Status      |
|----------------|------------|------------------|----------------------|-------------|
| Image (HA)     | 3          | 0.791            | 0.679                | Reliability |
| Social (XH)    | 3          | 0.838            | 0.719                | Reliability |
| Education (GD) | 3          | 0.816            | 0.740                | Reliability |
| Health (SK)    | 3          | 0.817            | 0.725                | Reliability |
| Identity (BS)  | 3          | 0.802            | 0.710                | Reliability |
| Economic (KT)  | 4          | 0.854            | 0.804                | Reliability |

#### 4.3. Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA)

“Exploratory Factor Analysis”, or EFA, is the process of condensing a collection of observable variables into a set  $F$  (where  $F < k$ ) of more significant factors. Large numbers of variables are routinely collected in research, and many pertinent observable variables interact with one another.

Table 5.4. KMO and Barlett’s Test

| KMO and Bartlett's Test                          |                    |          |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------|
| Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin Measure of Sampling Adequacy. |                    | .698     |
|                                                  | Approx. Chi-Square | 2974.325 |
| Bartlett's Test of Sphericity                    | df                 | 171      |
|                                                  | Sig.               | .000     |

Table 5.5. Rotated Component Matrix

| Rotated Component Matrix <sup>a</sup> |           |   |   |   |   |   |
|---------------------------------------|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|
|                                       | Component |   |   |   |   |   |
|                                       | 1         | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
| KT3                                   | .851      |   |   |   |   |   |



|                                                                  |      |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--|
| KT4                                                              | .840 |  |
| KT1                                                              | .829 |  |
| KT2                                                              | .810 |  |
| XH3                                                              | .900 |  |
| XH2                                                              | .859 |  |
| XH1                                                              | .845 |  |
| GD3                                                              | .856 |  |
| GD1                                                              | .853 |  |
| GD2                                                              | .844 |  |
| SK3                                                              | .867 |  |
| SK1                                                              | .858 |  |
| SK2                                                              | .838 |  |
| BS3                                                              | .857 |  |
| BS1                                                              | .843 |  |
| BS2                                                              | .835 |  |
| HA1                                                              | .856 |  |
| HA2                                                              | .830 |  |
| HA3                                                              | .825 |  |
| Extraction Method: Principal Component Analysis.                 |      |  |
| Rotation Method: Varimax with Kaiser Normalization. <sup>a</sup> |      |  |
| a. Rotation converged in 5 iterations.                           |      |  |

Based on the data, we see the following results:

- A sufficient criterion is that the KMO coefficient (Kaiser–Meyer–Olkin) must attain a value of 0.5 or greater

( $0.5 \leq KMO \leq 1$ ). This study's scale, which is 0.768, is accepted.

- To evaluate observed variables and determine whether or not the factors are associated, Bartlett's test of sphericity is employed. This questionnaire's Bartlett test result is 0.000 (sig Bartlett's Test < 0.05), demonstrating the factor's observed variables' correlation with one another.
- A popular criterion for figuring out how many internal components to include in an EFA analysis is eigenvalue. Only factors with an Eigenvalue of > 1 are retained in the analytical model according to this criterion. The findings of this study indicate that we could retain each of the six components.

#### ***4.4. Frequency and Ratings***

Six items about the participants' perceptions of cultural institutions were asked questions. On a Likert scale ranging from 1 to 5, participants were asked to rate their answers in the questionnaire. The data for each category is broken down below, and from there, we have determined which criteria have the highest and lowest ratings.

With a score of 3.44, this indicates that students in Thu Duc City are particularly interested in the “Economic” advantages of cultural organizations as well as how they support regional and national economies. Having a score of 3.43, “Health” follows, indicating the significance of the advantages associated with mental health. With a score of 3.4, the “Education” component came in third place and confirmed the significance of cultural institutions as valuable learning resources. “Identity” comes in fourth with 3.39, which aids in our understanding of society and ourselves. The fifth category, "Social," discusses the advantages that link life with 3.35 and social interactions. The "Image" category, which has a score of 3.32 and is associated with the area's popularity and reputation, is ranked last.

Table 5.6. Scored Point Result

| Factor      | N of Items | Minimum | Maximum | Average Point |
|-------------|------------|---------|---------|---------------|
| Image (HA)  | 3          | 1       | 5       | 3.02          |
| Social (XH) | 3          | 2       | 5       | 3.1           |

|                |   |   |   |      |
|----------------|---|---|---|------|
| Education (GD) | 3 | 3 | 5 | 3.08 |
| Health (SK)    | 3 | 4 | 5 | 3.06 |
| Identity (BS)  | 3 | 5 | 5 | 3.08 |
| Economic (KT)  | 4 | 6 | 5 | 3.27 |

## 5. Discussion/Conclusion

The aforementioned research demonstrates that scholars have recognized the multifaceted nature of cultural institutions as a topic in need of further investigation. Cultural values are frequently intricate and challenging to quantify. Based on earlier research, this study investigated each person's perception of the worth of cultural organizations using the data set that was gathered. The six components of the measure are image, health, education, economic development, social capital, and identity/cultural capital. An image is the smallest factor and the economic factor is the largest. The findings of the research indicate that this scale can be used in real-world settings to assist decision-makers in determining how cultural values are distributed throughout society. However, it should be noted that this scale is based on each individual's perception and may change over time. Therefore, it is necessary to continue researching and perfecting this scale to be able to more accurately assess the value of cultural institutions in society. In addition, this study also opens up many new research directions on the nature and role of cultural institutions in modern society.

## 6. Recommendations

In the future, research articles may choose a specific cultural facility, such as a museum, art center or library, as the research object. This approach would allow for a deeper exploration of the perspectives of survey participants as well as identify strengths or problems that the facility is facing. Furthermore, focusing on one organization will help analyze the factors that influence visitor attraction and retention, leading to more specific recommendations. Additionally, research could be done on their motivations and preferences when visiting cultural institutions. For example, research can find out factors such as: the primary reasons they choose to visit, the activities they wish to engage in during their visit, external factors affecting the decision to visit. Through collecting and analyzing data about these motivations and preferences, cultural facility managers can adjust their strategies, design more relevant programs, and create more engaging

and unique experiences for visitors, thereby increasing the number of visitors and their satisfaction.

## **7. Limitations**

One notable limitation of this study is the narrow scope of the survey and the relatively small number of participants, which may lead to results that are not representative of the entire student population in Thu Duc City. According to random sampling theory (Bennett, 2010), to achieve highly reliable results, the sample size must be large enough and representative of the population's characteristics to avoid bias in the data and ensure the accuracy of the conclusions drawn from the research.

Additionally, many participants did not have a clear understanding of Cultural Institutions, which may lead to inaccuracies in evaluating the social value that these organizations provide. According to Cognitive Theory (Eysenck & Keane, 2015), the knowledge and understanding of participants directly influence how they process information and form judgments. Furthermore, the study only posed general questions about perceptions of cultural institutions without targeting a specific organization or unit. Respondents may have differing views on various cultural institutions, which can create confusion and lead to inconsistent responses that do not accurately reflect their thoughts.

Another limitation of this research is that the data analysis was not conducted at a deeper level, as it only utilized Reliability Testing and Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA) without advancing to more sophisticated methods such as Regression Analysis, Confirmatory Factor Analysis (CFA), or Structural Equation Modeling (SEM). Therefore, the study may not have thoroughly explored and analyzed the correlations between the identified factors.

These factors need to be carefully considered in future studies to enhance the accuracy and reliability of the results. Expanding the scope of the survey, increasing education and information for participants, as well as designing more specific questions and targeting defined groups will be important steps to improve research quality and ensure that the conclusions drawn have practical value.

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campaigns on "Cultural Institutions". More research is necessary to quantify the true social benefits linked to students' opinions on the worth of cultural institutions, though. We spent seven weeks conducting a fruitful and ongoing study, data collection, and investigation. Our research indicates that an increasing number of students recognize and value the contribution that cultural institutions make to society.

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